

.....

1. Say “take your time” and mean it.

.....

Truly, I am not one of those people who wait until the cashier finishes ringing up all purchases before *starting* to look for a form of payment; my card-sliding, coin-counting (pre-sorted), and button-pressing prowess has not stopped the next in line from pressing forward, snooping over my shoulder as I finish my transactions, clearly violating my space, and acting as if the millisecond of waiting for my receipt shows that I am hopelessly slow and not worthy of occupying a square inch of shopping-floor space. Though I am not patient naturally, my disdain for the hurry-uppers has calmed me and seems to be contagious. However, don't take kindness and patience as license to be oblivious to the needs of others.

.....

2. Ask your friends if they want to borrow your stuff, not randomly, but upon detection of a need.

.....

For example, I offered my pet carrier to neighbors who needed something to transport a newly adopted dog. My sister-in-law bought the carrier for our family so it seemed natural to share this gift. And, when my son's friend

went on his first-ever ski trip, it made sense to offer an extra pair of long underwear; they're expensive to buy and easily outgrown by a teenager. I've also been the beneficiary of an offer when a friend let my family borrow his tent for our first Scout camping trip; we've since bought our own but it was nice to test drive one (and let our son decide if he wanted to stick with Scouts).

.....

3. Invite someone to join your group.

.....

It can be one that meets regularly, such as your book club or mom's group, or an impromptu gathering for a bike ride or potluck dinner. You might be turned down, but you also might be surprised, as I have been, at the impact of a quick phone call. I invited someone to my women's group at church several months ago and was surprised that 1) she had really wanted someone like me to issue an invitation in order to feel welcome, and 2) she had been one of the charter members, but had gotten busy over the years with work and single parenthood.

.....

4. Use your turn signal.

.....

Judging from my experience on the road, the turn signal is an underused but highly valuable device. Whether